

Tiptop Virtual Academy Decision Architecture

How the Academy Thinks

Version: 2.0 Foundation Draft

Purpose

The Decision Architecture defines every significant institutional decision made within Tiptop Virtual Academy.

It establishes **what decisions exist, who owns them, what information they require, what laws govern them, whether Artificial Intelligence may assist, and what outcomes they may produce.**

The Academy recognizes that processes exist to execute decisions.

Technology exists to support decisions.

Information exists to improve decisions.

People remain accountable for decisions.

By explicitly modelling institutional decisions, the Academy ensures consistency, transparency, fairness, accountability, and continuous improvement.

Principles

Principle 1 — Every Decision Exists for a Purpose

A decision shall exist only if it contributes to the mission of the Academy.

Unnecessary decisions create unnecessary complexity.

Principle 2 — Every Decision Has an Owner

Every institutional decision has one accountable decision owner.

Advice may come from many sources.

Accountability belongs to one.

Principle 3 — Every Decision Uses Evidence

Decisions are informed by:

- Institutional information
- Policies
- Professional judgment
- Educational expertise
- Applicable laws
- Institutional Rules
- Historical evidence

Never by assumption alone.

Principle 4 — AI Advises

Artificial Intelligence may recommend.

Artificial Intelligence may analyse.

Artificial Intelligence may predict.

Institutional accountability remains human unless explicitly delegated by policy.

Principle 5 — Every Decision Creates an Outcome

Every decision produces one or more consequences.

No decision exists in isolation.

Decision Categories

Admissions Decisions

Examples include:

Should this applicant be admitted?

Is the application complete?

Should an interview be scheduled?

Has the applicant met admission requirements?

Should admission be deferred?

Should an application be rejected?

Decision Owner

Student Lifecycle Domain

Evidence

Application

Documents

Interview

Policies

Capacity

Possible Outcomes

Accept

Reject

Request Information

Waitlist

Defer

Enrollment Decisions

Examples:

Can enrollment begin?

Has payment satisfied policy?

Are mandatory documents complete?

Should enrollment be suspended?

Should enrollment be cancelled?

Academic Decisions

Examples:

Is this lesson ready?

Should this assessment be published?

Has learning been achieved?

Should this learner progress?

Should intervention occur?

Should graduation be approved?

Teaching Decisions

Examples:

Which teacher should teach this subject?

Should workload be adjusted?

Should mentoring be provided?

Has professional development been completed?

Student Support Decisions

Examples:

Does this learner require intervention?

Should pastoral support be initiated?

Should parents be contacted?

Should attendance concerns be escalated?

Financial Decisions

Examples:

Should an invoice be issued?

Has payment been received?

Should a refund be approved?

Should a scholarship be granted?

Should an account be restricted?

Governance Decisions

Examples:

Should this policy change?

Should a risk be escalated?

Should an audit begin?

Should corrective action be approved?

Technology Decisions

Examples:

Should a user receive access?

Should an integration be enabled?

Should AI recommendations be accepted?

Should an incident trigger emergency response?

Quality Decisions

Examples:

Has quality standard been achieved?

Should improvement be initiated?

Should accreditation evidence be accepted?

Decision Anatomy

Every institutional decision shall define:

Decision Name

Purpose

Decision Owner

Participating Roles

Triggering Event

Required Information

Institutional Laws Applied

Business Policies Applied

AI Assistance

Permitted

Restricted

Prohibited

Possible Outcomes

Resulting Events

Audit Requirements

Decision Flow

The Academy recognizes the following pattern:

Event



Decision Required



Evidence Collected



Institutional Laws Applied



Policy Applied



Professional Judgment



Decision Made



Outcome Produced



New Event Created

Every decision transforms information into action.

Decision Quality

Excellent decisions are:

Timely

Evidence-based

Consistent

Fair

Transparent

Auditable

Aligned with institutional values

Decision Authority

Decisions should always be made:

by the appropriate authority,

using the best available evidence,

at the lowest responsible level,

with clear accountability.

Artificial Intelligence

Artificial Intelligence participates as a Decision Support Capability.

AI may:

analyse,

predict,

recommend,

prioritize,

summarize,

identify anomalies.

AI shall not replace institutional accountability.

Closing Statement

The Decision Architecture defines how Tiptop Virtual Academy converts information into action.

By making institutional decisions explicit, the Academy creates a transparent, accountable, evidence-based approach to leadership, education, governance, and continuous improvement.

Every workflow, every AI capability, every policy, and every software feature ultimately exists to support sound institutional decision-making.